

What if every SaaS subscription was a per-call ingredient?

A field study of 13,517 paid API routes on x402.

RouteSignal · routesignal.pages.dev

Per-call paid APIs just became real.

x402 made it trivial to charge per HTTP call.

No accounts. No API keys. No subscriptions. Just USDC + a header.

In the last few months, 1,753 publishers shipped 13,517 paid routes.

Permissionless supply formed faster than anyone has mapped.

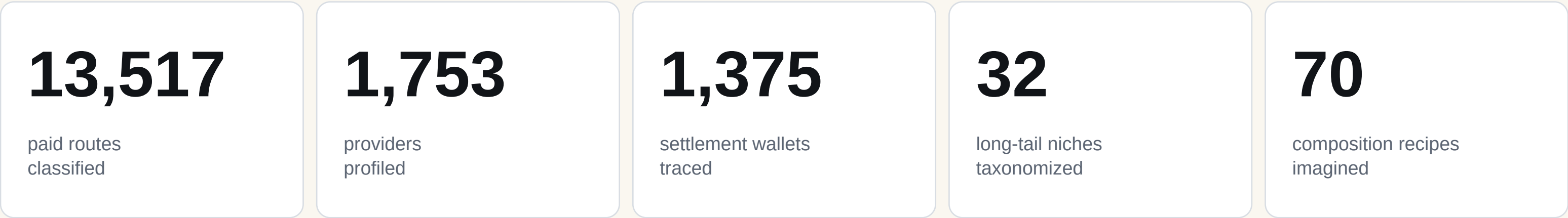
The interesting question stopped being:

"Can an agent pay an endpoint?"

It became:

What becomes possible when 13,517 of them exist?

We mapped it.



Open artifacts (all on the front page):

- [Insights.md](#) · [long-tail.csv](#) · [PossibleRecipesByChefClaude.md](#)

FINDING 01

The active surface is small and named.

321 routes

carry \$532,290 / 30 days · 98.7 % of all observed volume

Named businesses, not noise:

BlockRun \$262,860 78 routes · 30d	StableEnrich \$108,680 38 routes · 30d	HYRE Agent \$73,920 56 routes · 30d	StableStudio \$68,400 50 routes · 30d	Nansen AI \$5,839 46 routes · 30d
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This is commerce, not testnet. Two providers — BlockRun + StableEnrich — drove 70 % of all volume.

FINDING 02 · THE WOW STAT

The publisher graph is 5–8× smaller than it looks.

1,753 listed providers

1,375 settlement wallets

Top 10 wallets = 32.9 % of all routes

Top 1 wallet = 12.8 % · 1,728 routes

The largest publisher on x402 by route count

has no public name yet — only a wallet.

FINDING 03

A Cambrian long tail of weird per-call ingredients.

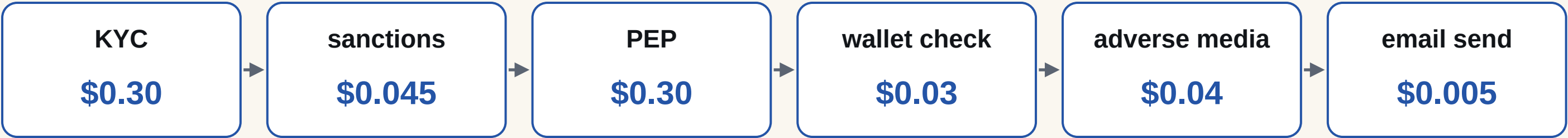
Sanctions / OFAC screen \$0.045	KYC / ID verify \$0.30	PEP / adverse media \$0.30	Wallet forensics \$0.03
Phone number buy \$1.77	Restaurant reservation \$0.10	Contact enrichment \$0.05	Maps / geocode \$0.028
Vedic natal chart \$0.75	Tarot reading \$0.01	Dream interpretation \$0.01	Cocktail recipe \$0.01
Pickup line generator \$0.001	Outfit recommender \$0.01	Color palette \$0.001	Lottery / lucky number \$0.01

All of these exist as paid routes today. None of them existed as buyable ingredients 18 months ago.

THE THESIS

Per-call APIs behave like Unix pipes.

The interesting unit isn't an endpoint. It's a chain.



= **Compliance-as-a-loop** · **\$0.72 / user**

replaces Persona + ComplyAdvantage seat · ~\$10,000–\$50,000 / year

The molecules exist. The chemistry does not — yet.

THE PROOF

We can imagine the chef.

Three recipes buildable today from routes already in the CSV:

Founder Background Check

\$0.40

contact enrich + adverse media + PEP + sanctions + wallet forensics + WHOIS

Replaces a 4-hour paralegal review (~\$800).

Plan-a-Date Agent

\$1.25

reservation + cocktail + outfit rec + pickup line + horoscope compat + SMS + Uber ride

Replaces Tinder Gold + OpenTable + stylist app (~\$60).

Memecoin Pre-Aping Stack

\$0.22

wallet forensics + sanctions on deployer + adverse media + WHOIS age + sentiment + DeFi read

Replaces \$99/mo alpha-group subscriptions. Pays for itself the first rug it prevents.

THE PATTERN

Every great recipe has the same shape.

5–10

cheap paid calls

30 sec

to execute

< \$2

total cost

\$50–\$2000per month SaaS
it replaces

This is the knowledge-work compression curve —

the same arc LLMs are riding for text, but for actions, lookups, and decisions.

Every monthly SaaS subscription is a future x402 recipe.

HONEST

What we don't know yet.

Most listed routes probably don't work great today.

Some are dead. Some are slow. Some return garbage. RouteSignal classifies listings — it does not yet verify endpoint quality at scale.

13,517 is a snapshot.

As per-call publishing gets cheaper, there will probably be millions of these routes within a year. The dataset is a starting point, not a census.

The composition layer does not exist yet.

Nobody is chaining routes in production. The recipes we propose are buildable — but the chef has not been built.

We mapped what is there. We did not yet prove what works.

PROBE → PAY conversion has not been measured. That is the next research step, and the only metric that proves x402 is forming, not just listing.

NEXT

What's next.

Now that the map exists, here are the questions we want to answer next:

01 Probe the catalog for real.

Convert PROBE → PAY / BLOCK by actually calling endpoints, not just reading listings.

02 Trace the hidden incumbent.

Identify the operators behind the top 10 settlement wallets that already control a third of the catalog.

03 Track PROBE → PAY weekly.

The only metric that proves x402 is forming — not just listing. Make RouteSignal the place this is measured.

04 Build the chef.

Turn the recipe book into a real orchestrator: take an intent, return a chain, settle the calls.

05 Open the dataset.

Make this a community map. Let other researchers extend the niche taxonomy and the recipe book.

06 Become the pre-spend layer.

Hook into agent vendors (Claude, Goose, etc.) as the discovery + verdict + composition layer agents call before paying.

CLOSE

Want to talk?

This is research, not a product launch. We mapped the early shape of an emerging market, and we want to discuss it.

**Every SaaS subscription you pay monthly
is a future x402 recipe.**

**We mapped the 13,517 ingredients.
Now we want to talk about who builds the chef.**

OPEN ARTIFACTS

[routesignal.pages.dev](#) · [Insights.md](#) · [long-tail.csv](#) · [PossibleRecipesByChefClaude.md](#)

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